

WHO'S LEADING WHO

● While Blinkit dominates quick commerce with its vast selection and network, Zepto claims to deliver in the shortest possible time

	BLINKIT	ZEPTO	SWIGGY INSTAMART
REVENUE FROM OPERATIONS (FY23 IN ₹ CRORE)	1,064	2,024	NA
NUMBER OF DARK STORES (AS OF JULY 2024)	526	350	500+
AVG DELIVERY TIME (IN MINS)	12.5	10	11-12
AVERAGE DAILY ORDERS	7,25,000	3,50,000	6,50,000
PENETRATION (AS OF JULY 2024)	26 CITIES	7 CITIES	33 CITIES

NOTE BLINKIT'S REVENUE JUMPED TO ₹2,302 CRORE IN FY24; DATA FOR FY24 IS NOT AVAILABLE (NA) FOR THE OTHERS; SWIGGY DOES NOT PROVIDE DATA SEPARATELY FOR INSTAMART
SOURCE ANNUAL FILINGS, BT RESEARCH



“We don’t concern ourselves with competition. We want to do better not just with every single transaction but also [with] every interaction on our platforms”

AADIT PALICHA
CO-FOUNDER & CEO, ZEPTO



that it was ahead of its time, perhaps too far ahead. It was believed that Indians preferred to stroll through their neighbourhoods to buy essentials rather than use an app. But then Grofers expanded to multiple cities, though it had to shut down some operations in 2019. Enter the pandemic, and everything changed. It was an inflection point. Rebranded as Blinkit, it introduced the first-of-its-kind 10-minute delivery service, sparking customer interest and proving the sceptics wrong. That set the stage for the company's rapid growth. In 2022, food delivery platform Zomato acquired it for ₹4,447 crore in an all-stock deal.



K. Ganesh, a serial entrepreneur and Founder of bigbasket, says the adoption, scaling up, and growth of quick commerce have caught everyone by surprise. He calls it one of the most significant developments in the e-commerce space. Tata Digital bought a majority stake in bigbasket in 2021.

Ganesh says the impact of quick commerce is clear if one considers the change it has brought about in customer behaviour. For a typical middle-class household, even in urban areas, there are three kinds of purchases: planned, top-up or essential, and instant purchases. Monthly planned purchases account for 80% of spends, top-ups are somewhere between 10% and 12%, and instant purchases account for 5–6%. Now, Ganesh says, top-ups have started

attracting a higher wallet or market share, and they're eating into planned purchases. “Customers love the quick delivery concept.”

Customers took to quick commerce so much that they started relying on it even for orders they previously scheduled for slotted delivery. That raised a critical question: if you can receive your order in 20 minutes, why wait for a scheduled slot?

Because of the enthusiastic adoption from customers, quick commerce firms are increasing their presence at a rapid pace. Zepto operates in seven cities, Blinkit in 26 cities, and Swiggy Instamart in over 30 cities. Blinkit is also making significant inroads into Tier II and III cities.

According to Aadit Palicha, Co-founder and CEO of Zepto, with